Editable pack for the bus boycott

Friday 15 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 2 | HUM-GROW-S1-W02

Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

Enquiry: What helped the campaign change bus rights?

In Montgomery, Alabama, USA, racist bus rules kept Black and White riders apart. Black residents had challenged these rules for years. Rosa Parks was arrested on 1 December 1955 after refusing to give up her seat. The bus boycott began on 5 December. Many people worked together to seek change.

You may point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. Reading aloud and public answers are optional. You may pass.

Today I can

I can find facts in short source summaries.

I can name a maker and say what a source can show.

I can use two sources to support my own conclusion.

Our shared enquiry

Fact Finder locates a claim. Source Checker asks who made it and what it can show. Swap after one card. Use S3 and S4 together, then keep your own source notes.

Your own work

In your book, keep source notes for three cards. For each, say what it tells us, who made the card and the record or history behind it, and what we can trust it for. Add a short conclusion using two source codes and one limit.

Choose one route. The source cards and detective prompts follow. The model is a teacher-written example, not a historical quotation.

Use the quiet signal to ask the adult for a pause. Use the agreed supervised place. No public reason is needed. Return with one small source check or a private recap when ready.

Your source enquiry

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Route Supported

Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

1 Use S1, S3 and S4. An adult may read each card exactly. Use the check mat and one question at a time.

2 In your book, use the three-source detective prompts. Point, speak or direct a scribe if needed. Choose a trust reason and explain it.

3 Write or dictate your own short conclusion with two source codes. Use the frame and add one thing the cards cannot tell us.

Your own finish

In your book, keep source notes for three cards. For each, say what it tells us, who made the card and the record or history behind it, and what we can trust it for. Add a short conclusion using two source codes and one limit.

Conclusion frame

The campaign sought ____. S__ shows ____. This helped because ____. S__ adds ____. I conclude ____. These sources do not tell us ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Keep the help used with your own work.

Your source enquiry

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Route Independent

Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

1 Choose three cards, including S3 and S4. Use the detective prompts in your book.

2 For each card, name the teaching writer and the maker behind it. Explain what it can show and one limit.

3 Write a short conclusion using two or more cards. Link teamwork and the legal case to change. Keep one limit clear.

Your own finish

In your book, keep source notes for three cards. For each, say what it tells us, who made the card and the record or history behind it, and what we can trust it for. Add a short conclusion using two source codes and one limit.

Conclusion frame

The campaign sought ____. S__ shows ____. This helped because ____. S__ adds ____. I conclude ____. These sources do not tell us ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Keep the help used with your own work.

Your source enquiry

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Route Aspire

Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

1 Use three or more cards, including S2, S4 and S5. Keep the same source notes and common finish.

2 Compare the early aims with the later legal change. Explain what changed. Do not assume all demands stayed the same.

3 Explain why a source made to persuade can still be useful. Note that two summaries based on the same record are not two separate proofs.

Your own finish

In your book, keep source notes for three cards. For each, say what it tells us, who made the card and the record or history behind it, and what we can trust it for. Add a short conclusion using two source codes and one limit.

Conclusion frame

The campaign sought ____. S__ shows ____. This helped because ____. S__ adds ____. I conclude ____. These sources do not tell us ____.

Plan in any language. Use your book, typing or exact scribing. Keep the help used with your own work.

Five sources for the bus boycott

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These five cards are new teaching summaries. The lesson writer made them in 2026. No old text or picture is copied. The record or history behind each card has its own maker and purpose.

S1 A call to stay off buses

Early December 1955 | Campaign leaflet

Jo Ann Robinson and other organisers helped spread a leaflet. It asked Black residents to avoid the buses on Monday 5 December. The first call was for one day. The protest then grew into a much longer boycott.

Maker behind this card: Women’s Political Council members and local leaders.

Purpose: To get people to join a protest.

Ask: Does a call to act prove that everyone joined?

Research basis: H1, H2.

S2 The early demands

About 8 December 1955 | Letter to the bus company

The MIA was the group that led the boycott. Its early demands included polite treatment, seats taken in order of arrival, and Black drivers on mainly Black routes. The seating plan still placed Black riders from the back and White riders from the front. These demands did not yet seek fully mixed seating.

Maker behind this card: MIA leaders, Martin Luther King Jr and U. J. Fields.

Purpose: To ask the bus company to change its rules.

Ask: Does a list of demands prove they were met?

Research basis: H1, H3.

Five sources for the bus boycott

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S3 Keeping the protest going

A later history, updated in 2022, about 1955–1956 | History article

Many people walked or shared car rides so they could stay off buses. Volunteers drove and helped arrange lifts. The MIA raised money to support this work. The campaign needed many people and steady effort, not just one famous leader.

Maker behind this card: US National Park Service.

Purpose: To explain how the boycott worked.

Ask: Can a short history tell us about every journey?

Research basis: H4, H1.

S4 The court ruling

5 June and 13 November 1956 | Court decisions described in a later history

Four Black women challenged bus segregation in the case Browder v. Gayle. On 5 June, federal judges ruled against the segregation laws. On 13 November, the US Supreme Court upheld that ruling. The legal case mattered as well as the boycott.

Maker behind this card: Courts made the rulings; the King Institute wrote the later history.

Purpose: To explain court decisions about bus segregation.

Ask: Does a court ruling tell us how every rider was treated?

Research basis: H5, H4.

Five sources for the bus boycott

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S5 A call to end the boycott

20 December 1956 | Prepared public statement

The court order had reached Montgomery. King announced that the boycott was ending. He asked Black residents to return to buses the next morning with the seating rule removed. His call shows what the leaders wanted people to do next. It does not, by itself, show every bus journey.

Maker behind this card: Martin Luther King Jr for the MIA.

Purpose: To announce the next step after the court order arrived.

Ask: How could we check whether the plan happened?

Research basis: H6.

Our task as source detectives

The new cards are summaries. We have not seen the old records. We can make careful claims using these checked accounts. We cannot judge the old paper, handwriting or picture from a summary.

Ask what a source is useful for. Give a reason and a limit. Check a claim against another source when possible.

Source detective sheet

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Learning outcome: Use sources to investigate a campaign for rights and change.

You may point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. Reading aloud and public answers are optional. You may pass.

Use this prompt sheet beside your book. Copy short headings or use the glue-in prompts. This is not a write-on worksheet.

Investigate three cards

Check	What to record in your book
Card	Write S__ and the topic.
What does it tell us	Choose a fact that helps answer our enquiry.
Who made it	This card: lesson writer, 2026. Behind it: name the record or history maker from the card.
Why was it made	Find the purpose. Was it a call to act, a decision, or a later account?
How far do I trust it	Useful for ____ because ____. It cannot prove ____.
What else would help	Name another card or kind of evidence to check.

Use the same checks three times

Keep the notes brief. A fact and a reason matter more than length. A source is useful for some questions and limited for others.

A purpose to persuade does not make a source false. Being official does not make a source complete.

These five cards are new teaching summaries. The lesson writer made them in 2026. No old text or picture is copied. The record or history behind each card has its own maker and purpose.

A short conclusion in your book

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What helped the campaign change bus rights?

Use at least two source codes. Link an action to how it helped. Include the legal case, as well as people's protest and support.

A frame you can use

The campaign sought ____. S__ shows ____. This helped because ____. S__ adds ____. I conclude ____. These sources do not tell us ____.

Check your claim

Did you use evidence from the cards? Did you explain how it supports your answer? Did you keep one limit? A plan is not proof of a result.

Glue in prompts if useful

Three source checks	My conclusion
What it tells us Who made this card and the record behind it What it can show What it cannot prove	Campaign aim S__ gives evidence S__ adds evidence My conclusion One limit

Use ready-cut prompts or ask an adult for help with cutting. Keep your own answers in your book.

Use the quiet signal to ask the adult for a pause. Use the agreed supervised place. No public reason is needed. Return with one small source check or a private recap when ready.